LAPTOP REVIVE

from E-waste towards Edu-power

Instruction Laptop Revive Laptop

This helps you to start

version 0.2

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Laptop Revive aims to make discarded laptops usable again by installing Linux on them and making them available free of charge to pupils and students who cannot afford to purchase a laptop for their studies. To achieve this, Laptop Revive collaborates with Humanitas, the Dutch Linux Users Group, and BuurtLinux.

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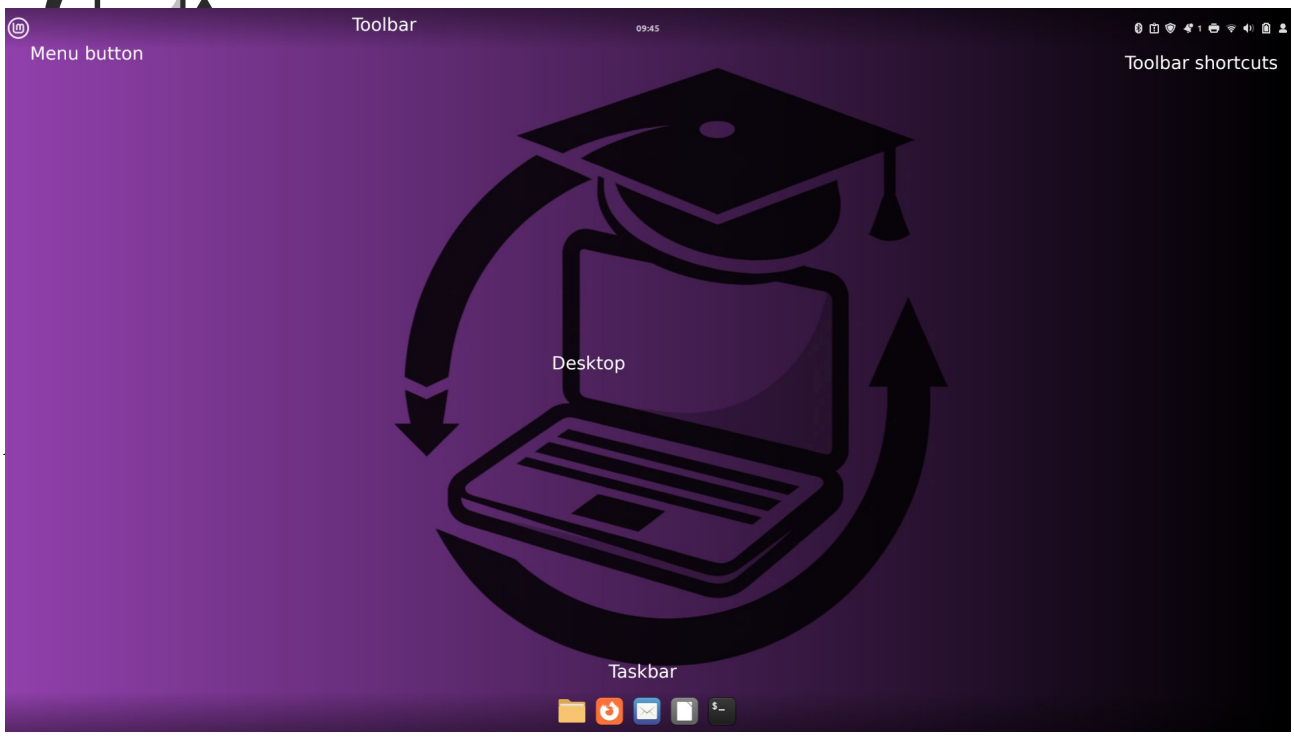


Picture 1: Startscreen of a Laptop Revive Laptop

Log in

When you start the PC, you'll see a login screen. You only need to enter a password at this screen. If you're using the laptop for the first time, the password is LaptopRevive. It's important to change the password quickly. Instructions for doing so are in the Changing your password on page 5.

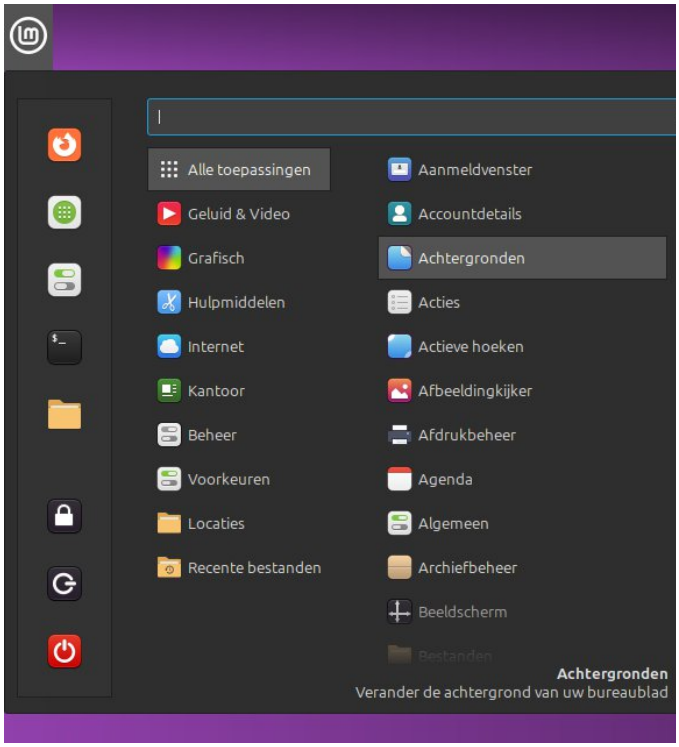
What you will see when you are logged in

Laptop Revive has set up the laptop to be as user-friendly as possible. On your screen you will see:

- The desktop, where you can place folders and files you use frequently and where the windows of the applications you're running are displayed.
- The toolbar at the top of the screen, containing the menu button and the various toolbar shortcuts.
- The taskbar at the bottom of the screen, where you can pin frequently used programs so you can launch them quickly.

The Menu

By clicking the menu button on the left side of the toolbar, you open a menu that lists all the programs installed on the laptop.



Picture2: The menu after clicking the menu button

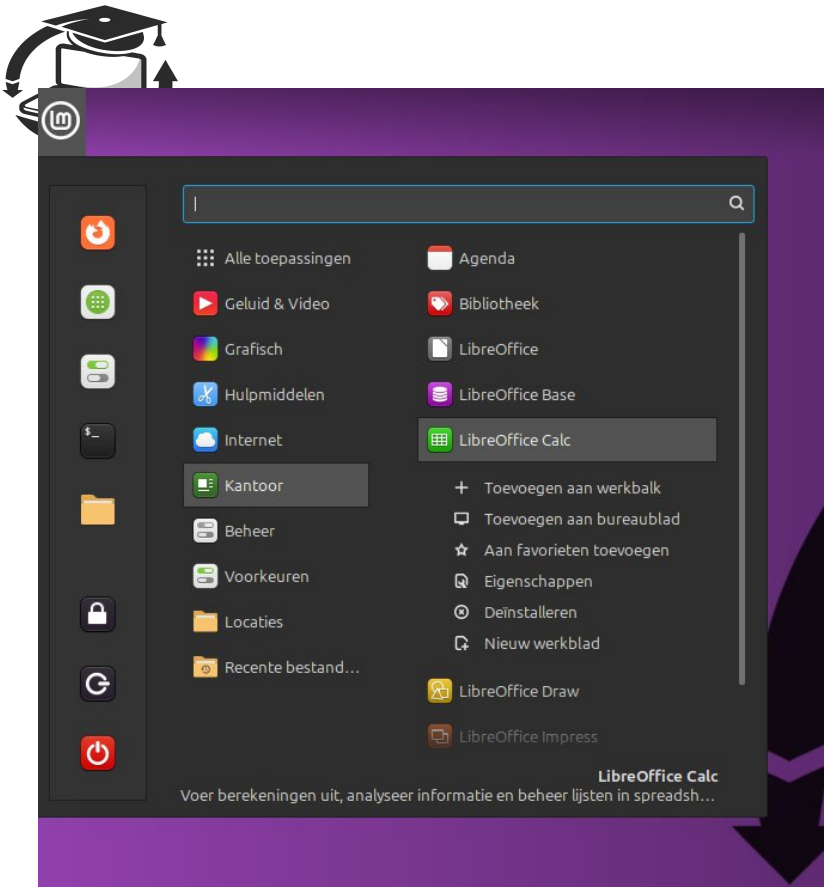
The menu is divided into three sections, from left to right:

1. **Favorites - the most frequently used items**
2. **Categories – the organization of programmes**
3. **Programmes within the categorie**

This layout lets you quickly find and launch a program by clicking on it.

You can also right-click a program to bring up a context menu, which lets you customize the menu and perform other actions.

In Picture 3: Context-menu for the LibreOffice Calc program on page 5 this is displayed. As you can see, this allows you to add a program to the toolbar, so you don't always have to open the main menu to launch it. You could also create a shortcut (launcher) on the desktop, but that isn't necessary because the taskbar already provides quick access.



Picture 3: Context-menu for the LibreOffice Calc program

This also applies to adding items to **Favorites**. Why use Favorites if you can place a program directly on the taskbar? Using the **Properties** option, you can rename a program in the menu—for example, you could rename **LibreOffice Calc** to **Spreadsheet** if that makes its purpose clearer. It is even possible to uninstall a program from the system.

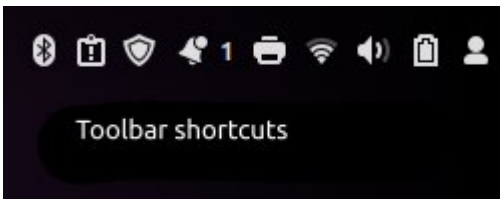
Changing your password

It's advisable to change the password right away—it's very easy. Open the menu using the menu button and, in the Favorites section, select the third option from the top: **System Settings** (Systeeminstellingen).

The **System Settings** window appears, and under the **Preferences** (Voorkeuren) section you click Account Details (Accountdetails).

By clicking Password (Wachtwoord), you can replace the current password (LaptopRevive) with a password of your choosing.

It's wise to set up a password manager to store passwords securely.. *In chapter Installing a program on page 9* a password manager is installed as an example.



De toolbar shortcuts

In the toolbar, you'll find the so-called Toolbar shortcuts on the right side. These provide important information or let you adjust key settings without having to look for them in the menu. Some programs you install may add their own toolbar shortcuts, which will also appear on the toolbar. When you first start using the laptop, you'll see the following panel widgets (presented from left to right):

- **Bluetooth - This lets you set up a Bluetooth mouse or Bluetooth earbuds.**
- **System report available** – Not always visible. This panel widget warns you if there's a problem or an important system update is available. Clicking it shows you what's going on (usually nothing noteworthy).
- **Update Management** – This panel widget turns red when an update is available. At that point you should click it and let the update run. With Linux you never have to worry about this—if an update exists, just apply it!
- **Notification** – This Toolbar shortcut isn't always visible. It appears when a program you're using has something to tell you.
- **Printers** – This toolbar shortcut gives you quick access to print management. If you don't have a physical printer, it's useful to know that Linux can also print to a file: your document or image is saved as a PDF instead of being sent to a hardware printer.
- **Network (Wifi)**
  This toolbar shortcut lets you connect to a Wifi-network
- **Sound Settings** – Use this shortcut to adjust your laptop's speaker volume up or down and to quickly access and modify the audio configuration.
- **Battery** – Shows how much charge remains and how long the laptop can keep running on battery power. From here you can also manage settings that affect power consumption, such as screen brightness and other related options.
- **Account Settings** – Here you can modify your account preferences, access the system settings, log out of the system, and shut down the computer.

Shutdown the laptop

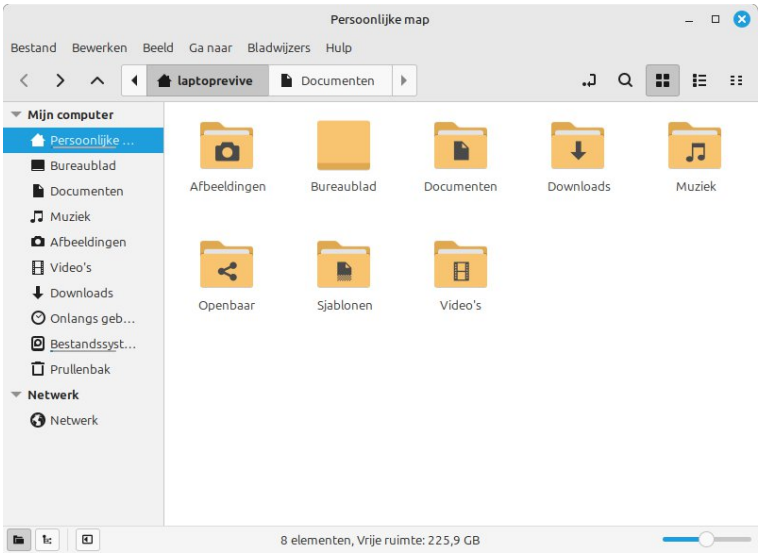
There are several ways to shut down the system:

- **Through the menu: Click the menu button, then scroll down in the Favorites section (on the left) until you reach the large red power button at the very bottom.**
- **Through the Account Settings panel widget: Click the little person icon, then choose Shut Down. Because the laptop typically has only one user, the Log Out and New User options aren't particularly useful.**

The system doesn't always have to be turned off. You can simply close the lid. When you open the laptop again you'll be prompted for your password, after which you can continue right where you left off.

⚠ **Be sure to save your work before closing the lid. Regularly saving your work is always a good habit.**

Folders, files and back-ups



Picture4: File manager on Laptop Revive

In the taskbar, the first program is File Manager. When you click it, the window shown in Picture 4. You can see that Linux already provides a sensible default layout that you can work with. With the file manager you can create new folders wherever you like. The recommendation is that if you create a folder primarily for documents, you should make it a subfolder under Documents. Keeping only a limited number of folders in your personal directory makes creating backups much easier.

Back-ups!!!

We cannot stress enough how important it is to make backups. A backup shouldn't be stored on the laptop itself but on a **removable medium** (a USB flash drive). Insert a USB stick into the computer; it will appear as **Device** (Apparaat) in the File Manager window. A new File Manager window automatically opens, showing the contents of the USB stick.

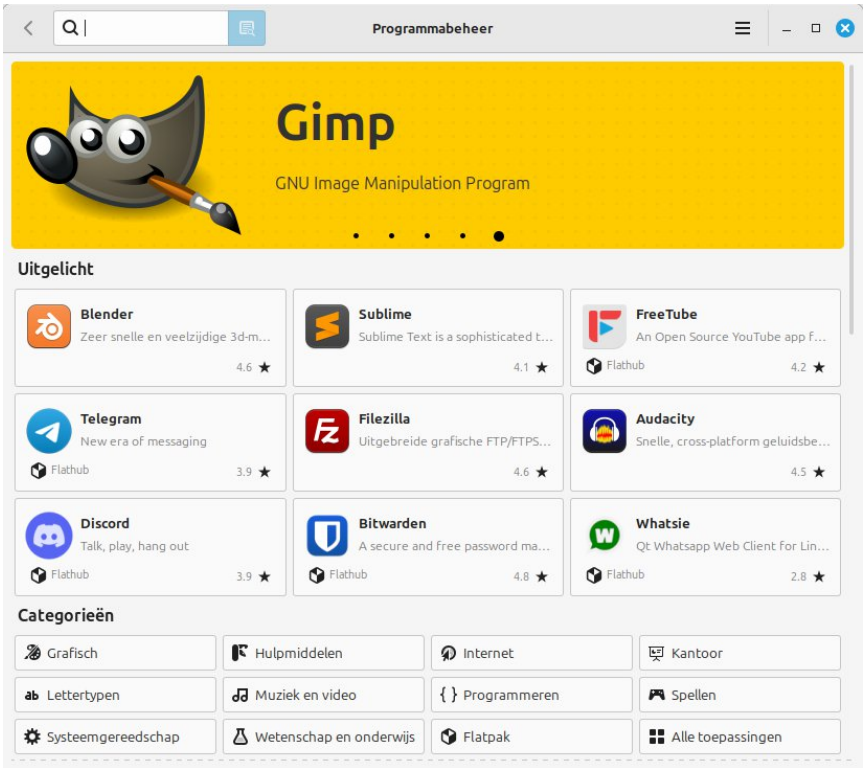
To create a backup, open another window (via the **File** (Bestanden) menu), then drag the folder you want to back up—e.g., Documents—into the USB-stick window. After that, all subfolders and files in the selected folder will exist both on the laptop and on the USB stick.

⚠ Important: You must never pull a USB stick out of the laptop without first ejecting it. Click the eject icon next to the USB stick under Devices (Apparaten) in File Manager before removing the drive.

Installing a program

As announced in the Changing your password chapter, this section shows how to install a new program. One advantage of Linux is that a Linux distribution comes with hundreds of applications pre-installed that you can use for free. Here we'll install the password manager KeePassXC.

The easiest way to install applications is through Software Management (Programmabeheer). Click the menu button and, in the Favorites section, select the second icon from the top: Software Management (Programmabeheer).



Picture5: Software Management

To make finding programs easier, the software manager uses categories that appear at the bottom of the window. Since KeePassXC is a utility, we click the **Utilities** (Hulpmiddelen) category.

In the Utilities view, KeePassXC is shown in the middle. Clicking it opens a window that displays information and ratings for the program, along with a button to install it. Occasionally, additional components need to be installed as dependencies; in those cases it's safe to click **Continue**—the same applies to KeePassXC. Installing any program requires you to enter your password to authorize the installation.

Installation should proceed smoothly. Once the installation completes, the program is automatically added to the menu, and you can optionally right-click it to add it to the taskbar if you wish.

Accented letters

Creating letters with accents and special symbols on a Laptop Revive device is done using a **Compose key**. In our case the Compose key is the right-hand key, which on most laptops is labeled **<Alt Gr>**. The table below shows how to “compose” those characters. Note that there is a slight difference between standard laptops and MacBooks.

Symbol	PC	Macbook
é,á,ú,ó,í	<alt gr>+<’>+<letter>	same
è,à,ù,ò,ì	<alt gr>+<`>+<letter>	<alt>(rechts)+<§>+e
ê,â,û,ô,î	<alt gr>+<6>+<letter>	same
€	<alt gr>+<5>	same

There are many more characters you can produce with **<Alt Gr>** (or the right on a MacBook). Feel free to give it a try.

Further support

It’s impossible to cover every topic in a brief introduction. After this short overview you’ll have enough knowledge to use the computer at a basic level. If you’d like to learn more or need assistance, you can arrange it yourself. Below are several websites where you can find information or request support:

- https://www.buurtlinux.nl for support if you encounter a problem you cannot solve.
- https://www.linuxmintnl.nl to get information about Linux Mint.
- https://nl.libreoffice.org to get information about Libreoffice.

As a Laptop Revive user, you can become a free member for one year of the Dutch Linux Users Group (NLLGG). This membership also gives you access to SLIM, the instant-messenger application for NLLGG members, where you can request support as well. See more at https://www.nllgg.nl.

Finally

The Laptop Revive team hopes you enjoy your laptop and that it helps you successfully complete your studies. We also hope you like Linux so much that you won’t want to work with anything else. That will contribute to reducing our future dependence on the big-tech companies (Google, Apple, Amazon, and Microsoft).